"IN THE BEGINNING..."

GENESIS 11

IN 5 MINUTES

When:

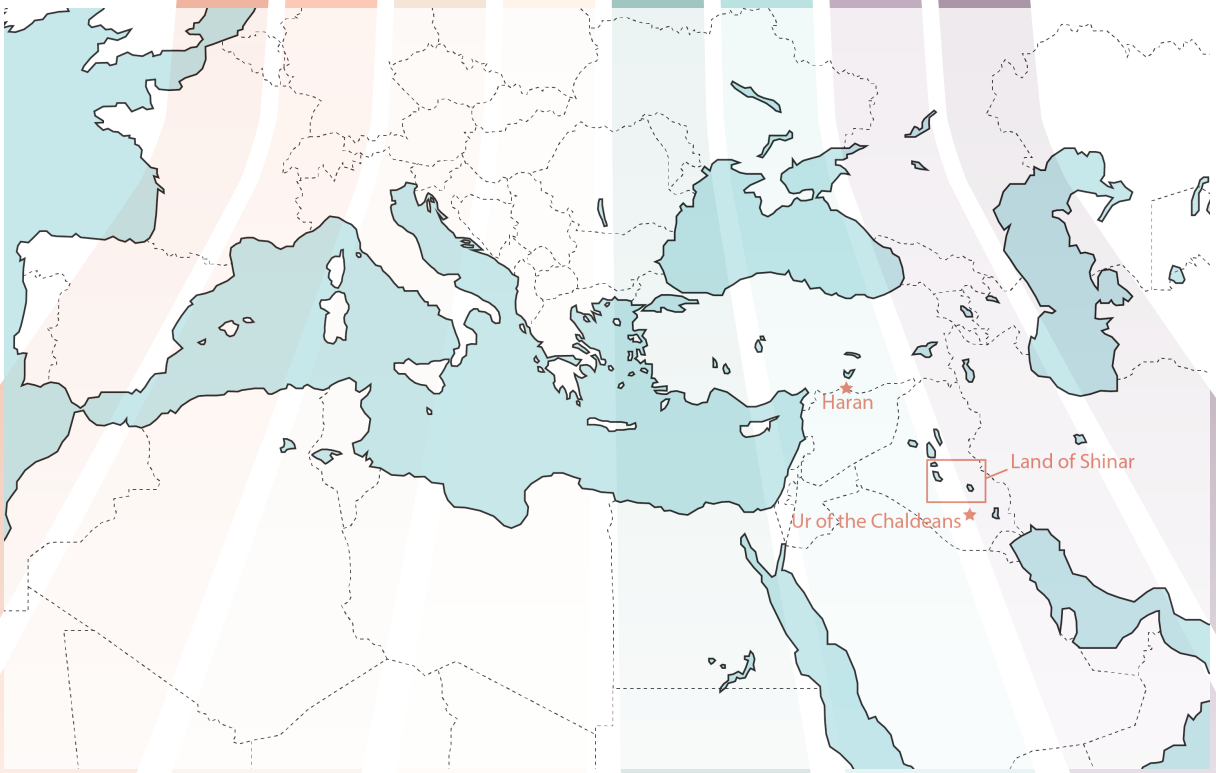
- The lifespan of humans decreased rapidly after the flood.
- Most historians date the flood to approximately 2350 B.C.
- Using the genealogy of Shem as recorded in verses 10-26, we can set the date of Abram's birth at approximately 1996 B.C.

Characters:

- **Shem's Descendants** – Shem's family tree is recorded in Genesis 11:10-26.
- **Terah** – Terah was the father of Abram, Nahor, and Haran.
- **Abram (Abraham)** – Abraham is known as the father of the Jewish nation. He is a key figure in God's plan to save mankind from sin.
- **Lot** – The son of Haran and nephew of Abram.

Where:

- The city and tower of Babel were built in the land of Shinar.
- Terah and Abram's families moved from Ur of the Chaldeans to Haran.



Outline:

- THE TOWER OF BABEL (11:1-9):
    + At this point in history, the whole world spoke the same language and many of them lived in the land of Shinar.
    + The people decided to "make a name" for themselves by building a city and a tower that reached heaven, but God had other plans for the human race.
    + After inspecting their work, God decided to separate them so they would scatter across the world rather than accumulate in one place.
    + He divided their languages so they couldn't communicate with one another.
    + The confusion resulted in them abandoning the tower project and dispersing "over the face of all the earth."
    +The city and tower became known as Babel, because it was there that God divided the languages.
- THE GENEOLOGY OF SHEM (11:10-26):
    + Shem fathered Arpachshad at 100 years old and died at the age of 600.
    + Arpachshad fathered Shelah at 35 years old and died at the age of 483.
    + Shelah fathered Eber at 30 years old and died at the age of 433.
    + Eber fathered Peleg at 34 years old and died at the age of 464.
    + Peleg fathered Reu at 30 years old and died at the age of 239.
    + Reu fathered Serug at 32 years old and died at the age of 239.
    + Serug fathered Nahor at 30 years old and died at the age of 230.
    + Nahor fathered Terah at 29 years old and died at the age of 148.
- THE FAMILY OF TERAH (11:27-32):
    + At 70 years old, Terah fathered Abram, Nahor, and Haran.
    + Haran's son was named Lot (we will read about him later).
    + Abram married Sarai and Nahor married Milcah.
    + Terah and Abram moved from Ur of the Chaldeans to Haran and settled there.
    + Terah died at the age of 205 years old.

Application:

- One thing that is very interesting to me is that the story of the Tower of Babel teaches us that God's will sometimes restricts innovation.
- Rather than allowing the humans to succeed in their technological and architectural endeavors, God thwarted them.
- Humans are allowed to advance technologically when God permits it, not before.
- Our modern developments have only been achieved by God's permission.
- No doubt, He is still withholding many secrets from researchers, scientists, and engineers.